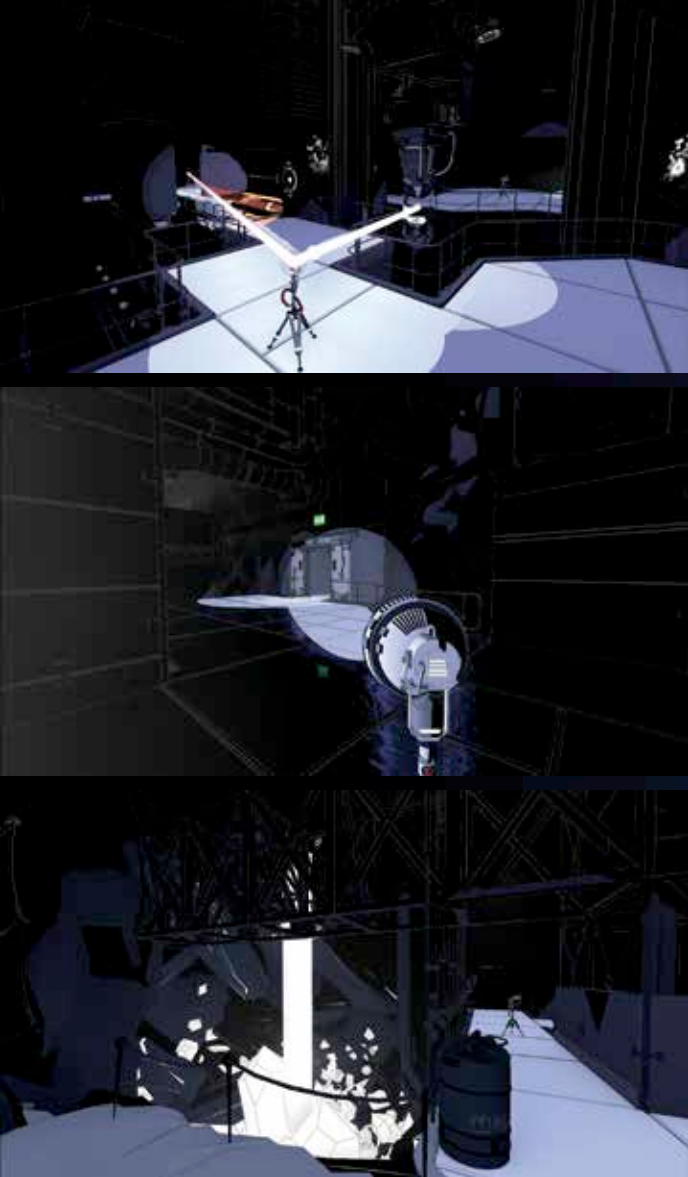




move, Space to jump and E or LMB to interact. That's pretty much it. Now, you might be wondering, couldn't one simply hold a lamp throughout the entirety of the game and get to the end? We thought that too but unlike other games where a lamp or any source of light spreads light in the form of concentric circles (thereby evenly illuminating all areas in the vicinity), in *LightMatter*, lamps act more like torches. If you pick up a torch and point it at something, you'll notice that the farther away you point it, the bigger the circle of light.

This is the reason why you can't just take a lamp and start walking. You'll have to place the lamp somewhere on the level in such a way that your pathway is illuminated. If you

pick up the lamp and start moving, the path directly beneath you will not be illuminated and you'll die.

GRAPHICS

The graphics for this game are abstract to say the least. The areas hidden in the lethality of the shadows only have the outlines of objects and nothing else.

We liked the overall art style of the game, however, looking at some of the reviews online, they're not for everyone. The colour palette is pretty muted and nothing really pops out of the background unless it was meant to, like an interactive button or a lamp. All the lamps and the buttons have a yellow highlight to indicate that the player can interact with them. The art style used in this game leans towards the cartoonish side but just a little bit. We still think the game is a treat for the eyes if

played at 1080p or higher on the maximum settings.

CONCLUSION

This game is a literal gem from start to finish. It samples and takes inspiration from *Portal* in a lot of ways and the best part is that the game actively embraces that. It's like the actual developer didn't want to just cash out on *Portal*'s concept and puzzles but actually pay homage to it. You can literally see and hear that in multiple instances. One of them is when the narrator says "... not like those folks at Aperture Science" and the best one so far is when *Portal 1*'s ending theme - *Still Alive* is sampled by the developer and put into the game as Level 28's soundtrack. How cool is that! The dev is literally paying respect to *Portal*'s team and using their idea.

All the *Portal* references and easter eggs aside, *LightMatter* is a really fun puzzle game with gameplay worth around 2 - 6 hours, depending on how good you are at solving puzzles. We definitely did not take 10 hours to complete the game and we definitely did not have to look at walkthroughs of the game just to see the solution of a particular puzzle.

The game's story is well written and the narrator's script is really good too. There's this one point in the game where the narrator takes a break and we are left alone for a few puzzles. Granted that the narrator does come back and starts his blabbering again, but solving those puzzles alone, without the narrator, made us realise how heavy and narrator driven this game is and that's not necessarily a bad thing too! The game has a lot going for it and it checks almost all the boxes that make up a good game.

We highly recommend that you check this game out. The ending will definitely surprise you and leave you wanting for more. To depict that feeling more accurately, we'd like to quote a review from Steam - "This game is like fast food. It's tasty and initially satisfying but leaves you wanting more." *

to get to the exit, you need to reach it in a way which doesn't kill you. We see you asking, what's going to kill you? The dark. This is a special type of "dark" you see, which dissolves all organic matter which enters it. Or, in the narrator's own words - "Think 'the floor is lava,' just with shadows that kill you,." So how does one get rid of the dark? By using light of course!

Every chamber will have one or more light lamps that you can use to your advantage. They can be used to lighting up dark areas in such a way that you can create a path to the exit sign. One of the reasons we liked this game so much was the simplicity of its objective. Like *Portal*, where your only objective was to complete test chambers, here too, your only objective is to escape the darkness.

GAMEPLAY

The controls are simple, WASD to